

Peakless, kilowatt.ie and bonkers.ie

The same thirteen homes through all three, every way in each offers, scored against the true cost of every plan. Run 5 October 2026.

WITH A METER FILE

A three-way tie on the sums

kilowatt.ie and bonkers.ie price your actual half-hours and land on the true cost (once kilowatt.ie's out-of-date levy is taken off). Peakless averages the file into a typical day per month: 0.2–1.2% out, but it picked the cheapest plan for all 12 homes.

TYPING YOUR USAGE

Peakless

Right plan for 11 of 13 homes against 5 (bonkers.ie) and 4 (kilowatt.ie). Both others assume a typical home uses far more at night than ESB's own profile says, and both assume an EV charges overnight.

CLOSEST RIVAL

kilowatt.ie

Hour-by-hour like Peakless, with batteries, EVs, solar, heat pumps, a winter/summer switch and live dynamic rates. It lists more plans, but mixes in ones a switcher cannot take and still charges last year's PSO levy.

How it was tested

The thirteen homes from the bonkers.ie report: small, typical and large; working from home; night-heavy; heat pump; storage heaters; an EV charged on a night timer and one at teatime; 4 kWp solar with and without a 10 kWh battery; rural; and an older 24-hour meter. Each is a year of half-hourly ESB readings with a known true cost for every plan. Each went through each site twice, typed and with the meter file, giving each site the answers it asks for (kilowatt.ie: EV kWh a night, solar size, battery size, heat-pump floor area). 75 runs in all.

Error is the median gap between a site's yearly cost and the true cost across every plan it prices. **Cost** is what following its top plan would cost against the truly cheapest. kilowatt.ie's figures have its €12.43 levy overcharge removed (see below); without that adjustment it is about 0.8% higher everywhere.

With the meter file

Home	bonkers.ie		kilowatt.ie		Peakless	
	Error	Cost	Error	Cost	Error	Cost
Small flat, 2,000 kWh	0.0%	€0	0.0%	€0	0.4%	€0
Typical home, 4,200 kWh	0.0%	€27	0.0%	€27	0.5%	€0
Large family, 7,500 kWh	0.0%	€30	0.0%	€30	0.5%	€0
Two working from home, 5,100 kWh	0.0%	€28	0.0%	€28	0.6%	€0
Night-heavy (immersion on a night timer), 5,000 kWh	0.0%	€0	0.0%	€0	0.2%	€0
Heat pump, 9,000 kWh	0.0%	€31	0.0%	€31	0.2%	€0
Night storage heaters, 11,000 kWh	0.0%	€0	1.1%	€0	1.1%	€0
EV charged 2am-5am, 6,700 kWh	15.0%	€0	0.0%	€0	0.2%	€0
EV charged at teatime, 6,700 kWh	13.9%	€173	0.1%	€29	0.4%	€0
4 kWp solar, no battery	0.0%	€0	2.1%	€0	0.5%	€0
4 kWp solar + 10 kWh battery	0.0%	€0	8.8%	€184	0.2%	€0
Rural typical home, 4,200 kWh	0.0%	€13	0.1%	€13	0.5%	€0

Typing the yearly usage

Home	bonkers.ie		kilowatt.ie		Peakless	
	Error	Cost	Error	Cost	Error	Cost
Small flat, 2,000 kWh	3.4%	€4	1.9%	€4	0.0%	€0
Typical home, 4,200 kWh	4.0%	€33	2.3%	€33	0.0%	€0
Large family, 7,500 kWh	4.4%	€81	2.3%	€81	0.0%	€0
Two working from home, 5,100 kWh	4.8%	€77	3.0%	€77	0.8%	€0
Night-heavy (immersion on a night timer), 5,000 kWh	0.1%	€0	2.4%	€0	0.2%	€0
Heat pump, 9,000 kWh	3.4%	€38	2.8%	€38	4.7%	€38
Night storage heaters, 11,000 kWh	14.1%	€0	19.0%	€0	4.1%	€0
EV charged 2am-5am, 6,700 kWh	3.1%	€0	2.4%	€0	0.2%	€0
EV charged at teatime, 6,700 kWh	14.1%	€302	11.6%	€302	0.1%	€0
4 kWp solar, no battery	2.8%	€0	23.4%	€0	2.2%	€0
4 kWp solar + 10 kWh battery	1.5%	€0	41.5%	€184	0.9%	€147
Rural typical home, 4,200 kWh	3.8%	€18	2.1%	€18	0.0%	€0
Typical home, older 24-hour meter	0.0%	€10	0.0%	€10	0.0%	€0

Totals

	Typed: right plan	Typed: € lost, all homes	File: right plan	File: € lost, all homes
bonkers.ie	5 of 13	€563	6 of 12	€302
kilowatt.ie	4 of 13	€747	5 of 12	€342
Peakless	11 of 13	€185	12 of 12	€0

One disputed price decides most of the file results. From 12 October Energia raises its standard rates. kilowatt.ie and bonkers.ie both show its discounts cut at the same time (Smart 24 Hour 30% → 28%, Smart Data 27% → 23%); Energia's own plan page still shows 30% and 27%, and its tariff page gives only the new standard rates. Peakless follows Energia's page, which keeps Energia Smart 24 Hour the cheapest plan for ordinary homes. **If the two comparison sites are right**, Flogas Smart 24hr is cheapest instead: kilowatt.ie's file results become 11 of 12 and bonkers.ie's 11 of 12, and Peakless's become 6 of 12, each miss about €27–31 a year. That is the single most important thing to confirm.

Where each one goes wrong

kilowatt.ie

- **Last year's PSO levy.** It charges €19.10; the levy fell to €6.67 on 1 October. Every quote is €12.43 too high. Its methodology page states the old figure.
- **Typed usage leans to night rates.** Its typical home puts 32% of use at night (ESB's standard profile: 23%), so it recommends Electric Ireland's day/night plan to most homes, €33–81 a year off for typical, large and working-from-home homes.
- **EVs are assumed to charge in the cheapest hours.** A car charged at teatime was sent to an EV night plan: €302 a year more. With the file it read the home correctly.
- **No storage-heater option:** typed, a storage home is 19% out.
- **Solar typed in needs the home's total use**, which a solar owner's bill does not show; even given it, its weather-based solar model gave costs 23% from this test's, so the solar figures depend heavily on whose solar model is nearer the truth.
- **Battery homes:** assumes a timer charging from the grid at night and recommends an EV plan (€184 a year off for a battery that only takes solar). Peakless does the same when typed, but now says so on screen.
- **Plans a switcher cannot take sit in the ranking:** Bord Gáis "Existing Customer" plans, SSE plans for smart meters with no signal, prepay and a "Winter/Summer split" scenario. Its number one for the solar-and-battery home was the split scenario.
- **SSE's main day/night/peak plan is missing.**

bonkers.ie

- As in the earlier report: a Nightsaver profile for every typed smart home, EVs assumed overnight, misread EV meter files (15% out), only 15 plans after an upload, and a false "incomplete data" warning.

Peakless

- **A meter file is averaged, not priced half-hour by half-hour.** 0.2–1.2% out where the other two are exact. It has not changed a recommendation in these tests, but it would matter for weekend and dynamic plans.
- **Heat pump typed:** 4.7% out and €38 off, against kilowatt.ie's 2.8% (kilowatt.ie models heat pumps from temperature).
- **Solar with a battery typed:** recommends an EV plan on the assumption of grid charging (€147), now flagged on screen with the answer without it.

Ease

	bonkers.ie	kilowatt.ie	Peakless
Typical home, typed	13 answers on one long form, then a results page	6 taps; results update on the same page as you answer	9 short questions, one at a time
With solar, a battery, a car	Export kWh; one EV switch	Solar kWp, battery kWh, EV kWh a night, heat-pump floor area	Roof, slope, panels, battery, mileage, car, charging time
Meter file to answer	12 taps, about 45 seconds; top 15 plans	About 7 taps, a few seconds; every plan	3 taps; every plan that suits the meter
Shows the working	Line-by-line per plan	Usage and cost per band on every card; import profile chart	Bill, hours, solar, car and accuracy tabs; PDF report

Every feature

Feature	bonkers.ie	kilowatt.ie	Peakless
Usage in			
Typed kWh / € bill	Both	kWh (annual or two-monthly)	Both
ESB meter file	Yes (top 15 shown)	Yes, priced half-hour by half-hour	Yes, averaged by month
Bill photo	Yes	No	No
The home			
Meter type, urban/rural	Yes	Yes, plus "smart, no signal" and 16 kW supply	Yes
Heating	No	Heat pump (floor area, temperature model)	Heat pump, storage, direct, gas; when it runs
Night immersion	No	No	Yes
EV	One switch	kWh a night, charged in cheapest hours	Mileage, car, and when it charges
Solar	Export kWh	kWp, weather-year model, clipping	Roof, slope, panels, hour by hour; payback and grant
Battery	No	Size, charge rate, timer or smart control, per plan	Size and use, per plan; says when grid charging is assumed
Plans			
Electricity plans, smart home	About 50	115 rows (each discount and payment variant, incl. existing-customer and prepay)	35

Gas, dual fuel	All suppliers	All suppliers, with a separate-vs-combined check	Five suppliers, dual-fuel homes
Dynamic plans	Filter	Live rates, half-hour shifting	Opt in
Winter/summer switch scenario	No	Yes	No
Custom discount	No	Edit per plan	Current plan's discount
Price rises, PSO levy	Included; current levy	Included; old €19.10 levy	Included from their date; current levy
After the answer			
Switching	Done for you (partner plans)	Links to the supplier	Links to the supplier
Solar quotes	No	Quote marketplace	Checks a quote you upload
Alerts, contract reminders	No	Not on the comparison	Yes
Extra tools	Other products (broadband, insurance)	Wholesale prices, solar dashboard, BER uplift, EV cost calculator	Analytics, PDF report, share card, quarterly suggestions
Accreditation, money	CRU-accredited; supplier commission	Not CRU-accredited; solar-quote referrals, no supplier affiliation stated	Not accredited; no supplier payments

What would close Peakless's gaps

- **Confirm Energia's discounts from 12 October.** Two independent sites say they fall; if so, Peakless's top pick for ordinary homes changes.
- **Price a meter file half-hour by half-hour**, as both rivals do, instead of averaging it by month.
- **Model heat pumps from temperature**, as kilowatt.ie does, for homes that type their usage.

Limits

- The homes are synthetic, built from ESB's published profiles; heat pump, storage, solar and battery behaviour are this test's own assumptions, so typed results for those homes are the least certain.
- The true cost uses each supplier's published prices as Peakless holds them. Where a site holds a different price (Energia from 12 October; Ecopower; Community Power's export rate; kilowatt.ie's Flogas day/night plan), its error here partly reflects that disagreement rather than its model.
- Gas, prepay and dynamic plans were not scored.

Run 5 October 2026 through each site's public comparison page in a browser, one session at a time with pauses. kilowatt.ie's robots file allows its comparison pages; bonkers.ie's data API, which its robots file bars, was not used. Homes, true costs, scripts and raw results are kept with the Peakless repository.